PHASES OF COLD WAR

1946–1949

The first phase of the Cold War was triggered off with the gradual consolidation of the Soviet influence in Eastern Europe and its inroads into the geo-strategic sphere of influence of the Western powers in Iran, Turkey and Greece. The situations in Greece, Turkey and Iran incited the United States to adopt an **interventionist foreign policy** against its erstwhile policy of isolationism.[6]

The crisis in Iran started, especially when the Russian troops failed to withdraw as per an allied agreement of 1942. Further, it was alleged that in the Soviet-occupied Iran, the Soviets encouraged local independence movements and even instigated a rebellion in Northern Iran and forced it to sign a Treaty which would give Russian access to Iranian oil. To ward-off the Soviet threat of expansion, the United States mounted pressure in the United Nations Security Council. With the United Nations intervention the Soviets finally withdrew, but the damage was already done. Determined US support for Iran was based on the belief that further Soviet expansion must be contained at any cost.

In Turkey, the Soviets demanded the internationalization of the Bosporus Strait, which had been under the Turkish control since 1936. During the Second World War, Churchill backed the Soviet claim but, when the divisions between the superpowers became evident, he fundamentally changed his position. Following the Soviet activities in Iran, the Allies apprehended a possible effort on the part of Soviet Union to expand its sphere of influence, and therefore, adopted gestures to resist the Soviet expansion.

In Greece, the Civil War, resulting from the guerilla warfare, led by the communists that launched attacks on the Greek government posed a threat to the Western powers. Britain, the traditional arbiter of the region, however failed to control the situation. Therefore, USA was called upon to counter the growing threat of the communist guerilla attacks. President Truman responded by approving legislation passed in the US Congress that permitted the President to send aid and military advisers to Greece. Subsequently, Truman